

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Scheme Performance, Convergence, Targeting and Data - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Scheme Performance, Convergence, Targeting and Data REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01 FOUNDATION — WHAT THE CAPSTONE OWNER HOLDS AND WHICH DEMANDS IT OWNS Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector	02 FOUNDATION — THE PERFORMANCE CYCLE AND THE ASSISTANCE UMBRELLA INSIDE IT The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural
03 FOUNDATION — THE TARGETING DATABASE AGAINST THE DECENNIAL ENUMERATION Evidence chain: The targeting database and why it is not the Census	04 CORE — TWO TARGETING ERRORS THAT TRADE AGAINST EACH OTHER Evidence chain: The two targeting errors and what each one costs
05 CORE — UNIVERSAL PROVISION AGAINST TARGETED PROVISION Evidence chain: Universalism against targeting as a design choice	06 CORE — THE MACHINERY BETWEEN A SANCTION AND A HOUSEHOLD The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are
07 CORE — CONVERGENCE AND THE TWO DIRECTIONS IT MUST WORK IN The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of	08 CORE — ONE HOUSEHOLD AND SIX MINISTRIES Technically, CORE — One household and six ministries is analysed by
09 CORE — WHY CONVERGENCE FAILS AND WHAT THE FAILURE LOOKS LIKE Evidence chain: Why convergence fails by design rather than by	10 CORE — THREE KINDS OF DATA AND THREE LEVELS OF RESULT Answering an outcome question with administrative data is a
11 CORE — THE OUTCOME INSTRUMENTS AND THE DISCIPLINE OF THE ROUND Every indicator must carry its survey round, and values from two	12 CORE — WHY TARGETING ERRORS SURVIVE A SOUND DESIGN The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the
13 CORE SYNTHESIS — WHY MEASUREMENT DOES NOT BECOME CORRECTION Prelims: Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official	14 CORE SYNTHESIS — THE PENDING ENUMERATION AND THE TRANSFER-EVIDENCE Evidence chain: The pending data event and what it does not yet
15 CORE SYNTHESIS — RIGHTS-RESPECTING REFORM AND THE OWNERSHIP STATEMENT Note: This is the CAPSTONE/synthesis topic for the Social Justice	

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this capstone owner holds and which demands are routed to it?

A. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. B. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. C. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. D. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under What this capstone owner holds and which demands are routed to it?

A. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. B. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. C. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. D. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this capstone owner holds and which demands are routed to it?

A. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. B. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two

exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. C. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. D. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this capstone owner holds and which demands are routed to it?

A. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. B. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. C. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. D. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of

welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The five-stage cycle that organises the whole topic?

A. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. B. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. C. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. D. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The five-stage cycle that organises the whole topic?

A. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. B. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. C. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. D. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The five-stage cycle that organises the whole topic?

A. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. B. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. C. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. D. The

owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The five-stage cycle that organises the whole topic?

A. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. B. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. C. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. D. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies The social-assistance umbrella and its five components?

A. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. B. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. C. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. D. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under The social-assistance umbrella and its five components?

A. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. B. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. C. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that

resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. D. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The social-assistance umbrella and its five components?

A. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. B. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. C. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. D. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme

providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The social-assistance umbrella and its five components?

A. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. B. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. C. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. D. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies The targeting database and why it is not the Census?

A. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. B. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly

needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. C. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. D. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under The targeting database and why it is not the Census?

A. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. B. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. C. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. D. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The targeting database and why it is not the Census?

A. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. B. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. C. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. D. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The targeting database and why it is not the Census?

A. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. B. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. C. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. D. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The two targeting errors and what each one costs?

A. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. B. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. C. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record

that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. D. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under The two targeting errors and what each one costs?

A. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. B. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. C. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. D. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The two targeting errors and what each one costs?

A. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. B. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. C. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. D. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The two targeting errors and what each one costs?

A. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. B. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. C. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates

database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. D. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Universalism against targeting as a design choice?

A. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. B. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. C. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. D. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Universalism against targeting as a design choice?

A. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. B. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. C. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. D. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Universalism against targeting as a design choice?

A. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. B. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. C. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces

exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. D. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Universalism against targeting as a design choice?

A. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. B. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. C. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. D. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication

that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies The delivery machinery between a sanction and a household?

A. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. B. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. C. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. D. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under The delivery machinery between a sanction and a household?

A. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. B. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier.

The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. C. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. D. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The delivery machinery between a sanction and a household?

A. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. B. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. C. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. D. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The delivery machinery between a sanction and a household?

A. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. B. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. C. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. D. The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies What convergence means and the two directions it must work in?

A. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. B. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health

assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. C. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. D. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under What convergence means and the two directions it must work in?

A. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. B. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. C. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. D. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The

chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What convergence means and the two directions it must work in?

A. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. B. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. C. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. D. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What convergence means and the two directions it must work in?

A. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. B. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. C. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. D. The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies The household that shows why convergence is hard?

A. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. B. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. C. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists

across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. D. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under The household that shows why convergence is hard?

A. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. B. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. C. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. D. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the

women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The household that shows why convergence is hard?

A. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. B. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. C. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. D. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The household that shows why convergence is hard?

A. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. B. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition

outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. C. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. D. The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Why convergence fails by design rather than by neglect?

A. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. B. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. C. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. D. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the

medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Why convergence fails by design rather than by neglect?

A. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. B. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. C. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. D. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Why convergence fails by design rather than by neglect?

A. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. B. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. C. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. D. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Why convergence fails by design rather than by neglect?

A. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. B. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while

certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. C. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. D. The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies What the failure looks like inside one household?

A. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. B. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. C. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. D. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under What the failure looks like inside one household?

A. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. B. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. C. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. D. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What the failure looks like inside one household?

A. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. B. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. C. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. D. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What the failure looks like inside one household?

A. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. B. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based

verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. C. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. D. The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Three kinds of data and what each one can and cannot say?

A. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. B. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. C. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. D. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Three kinds of data and what each one can and cannot say?

A. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. B. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. C. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. D. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Three kinds of data and what each one can and cannot say?

A. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. B. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. C. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. D. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Three kinds of data and what each one can and cannot say?

A. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. B. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. C. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs

approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. D. The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Output, outcome and impact as three different results?

A. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. B. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. C. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. D. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically

captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Output, outcome and impact as three different results?

A. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. B. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. C. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. D. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Output, outcome and impact as three different results?

A. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. B. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national

policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. C. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. D. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Output, outcome and impact as three different results?

A. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. B. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. C. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. D. The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an

administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The outcome instruments and the discipline of the round?

A. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. B. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. C. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. D. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under The outcome instruments and the discipline of the round?

A. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. B. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. C. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. D. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The outcome instruments and the discipline of the round?

A. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. B. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that

the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. C. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. D. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The outcome instruments and the discipline of the round?

A. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. C. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work

opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. D. The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Why targeting errors arise even when the design is sound?

A. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. B. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. C. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. D. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not

captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Why targeting errors arise even when the design is sound?

A. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. B. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. C. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. D. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Why targeting errors arise even when the design is sound?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. B. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. C. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. D. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Why targeting errors arise even when the design is sound?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen

marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. B. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. C. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. D. The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Why evidence does not become correction?

A. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. B. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. C. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access

rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. D. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Why evidence does not become correction?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. B. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. C. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. D. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and

work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Why evidence does not become correction?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. B. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. C. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. D. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their

findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Why evidence does not become correction?

A. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. B. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. C. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. D. The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies The pending data event and what it does not yet supply?

A. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. C. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. D. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under The pending data event and what it does not yet supply?

A. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution

that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. B. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. C. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. D. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The pending data event and what it does not yet supply?

A. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. C. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published

database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. D. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The pending data event and what it does not yet supply?

A. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. B. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. C. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. D. The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing

operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies What the transfer evidence actually supports?

A. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. B. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. C. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. D. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under What the transfer evidence actually supports?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. B. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. C. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. D. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What the transfer evidence actually supports?

A. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. B. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified

rather than assumed to be one current list. C. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. D. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What the transfer evidence actually supports?

A. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. B. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. C. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. D. The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food

security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies The reform architecture and the rights limits on it?

A. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. B. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. C. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. D. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under The reform architecture and the rights limits on it?

A. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. B. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. C. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. D. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The reform architecture and the rights limits on it?

A. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. B. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. C. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. D. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The reform architecture and the rights limits on it?

A. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. B. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak

to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. C. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. D. The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies How the two routed demands are owned and divided?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. B. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. C. The owners mark this as the capstone or synthesis topic of the Social Justice folder, to be read after the sixteen preceding owners, because it integrates targeting, convergence and data-architecture concepts across them and cross-links rather than re-deriving their content. Its subject is the

complete performance cycle by which a social-sector promise becomes a measured capability change. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands here and records both as core routes that supersede the older Advanced ownership: the 2019 question numbered 18 on the performance of welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the 2023 question numbered 17 on development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable being discriminatory in approach. Both are solved in this package with model answers written to the examiner-grade standard. D. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole.

Answer: A. Explanation: The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under How the two routed demands are owned and divided?

A. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. C. The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. D. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use.

Answer: B. Explanation: The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of How the two routed demands are owned and divided?

A. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. B. The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. C. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. D. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use.

Answer: C. Explanation: The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about How the two routed demands are owned and divided?

A. The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. B. The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. C. The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. D. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed.

Answer: D. Explanation: The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

This owner's previous-year record is a verified Mains ownership of exactly two demands, and it is stated precisely together with the boundary of what is claimed. The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes the 2019 General Studies Paper II question numbered 18 here, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes that are implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words; and it routes the 2023 General Studies Paper II question numbered 17 here, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons for the answer, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. For both the ledger records that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and the Basic owner's

answer architecture records the same ownership in the same terms. Both demands are therefore solved in this package with model answers written to the repository's examiner-grade standard using the claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification pattern. No further demand is claimed: the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and the audited 2018-2023, 2024-2025 and 2026 Prelims routing ledgers route no additional question to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no General Studies Paper II question in the audited 2024-2025 papers directly names the social-assistance umbrella, the targeting database or convergence. Alongside the two solved demand cards, the package adds six original Mains questions with model solutions and eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation, each model solution opening with its analytical claim so that the evidence which follows does argumentative rather than decorative work. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm the printed wording of the two routed Mains demands; no question was invented from them, no marking scheme or page precision was imported and no official answer key is claimed for any question anywhere in this package.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Define the vulnerable group, deprivation, right or policy concept and distinguish the nearest legal and measured category. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Identify the constitutional, statutory, judicial or executive basis and the competent Union, state or local institution. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Map rights-holder, household/community context, duty-bearer, frontline worker, provider and accountability forum. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace identification, eligibility, documentation, finance, access, portability, grievance, appeal and correction. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Use a named Indian law, judgment, scheme, institution or official dataset with source, date, denominator and status. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test intersectionality, regional variation, stigma, accessibility, privacy, fiscal adequacy, exclusion and causal limits. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: No direct GS-II Mains PYQ in 2024-2025 on this topic. The targeting-error and convergence concepts are foundational and will recur in any scheme-evaluation question.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	GS-II	18	Welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and awareness and involvement	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-II	17	Development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable as discriminatory	Do you agree and give reasons · 15 marks · 250 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and awareness and involvement
- Development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable as discriminatory

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: No direct PYQ; apply the targeting-convergence-outcome framework to any future

scheme-evaluation question: (1) identify targeting-database used, (2) trace delivery machinery, (3) diagnose convergence gaps, (4) triangulate administrative coverage with survey outcomes, (5) recommend correction loop.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2023
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2019	GS-II	18	Welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and awareness and involvement	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic; word limit taken from the instruction block	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-II	17	Development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable as discriminatory	Do you agree and give reasons · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic; word limit taken from the instruction block	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Welfare schemes for vulnerable sections and awareness and involvement
- Development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable as discriminatory

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 General Studies Paper II

Demand: Performance of welfare schemes that are implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger and as printed in the locally held official question paper.

Status: Routed to this owner by the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger with the recorded note that this core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and recorded in the Basic owner's answer architecture as an ownership held here. The printed wording was confirmed against the locally held official General Studies Paper II of 2019; no official answer key, marking scheme or model answer is claimed from that paper, and the solution below is original.

Model solution: Claim: the demand contains an embedded causal assertion, that ineffectiveness is due to the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the mark-bearing answer is one that agrees with participation as a real and underweighted cause while showing that it is one link in a five-stage cycle whose other links fail independently, so participation is necessary and not sufficient. Named evidence and analysis, stage by stage. At targeting, the deprivation database of 2011 is over a decade old, documentation proxies for identity rather than need, and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for consumption poverty; a household excluded here is excluded before any question of awareness arises, which is why an awareness campaign cannot reach a person the list does not contain. At delivery, the transfer rail, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement move money reliably while the frontline cadres, the auxiliary nurse midwife, the health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, each serve one scheme and hold no household-wide view, so the person best placed to inform a family about a second entitlement has no institutional reason to know of it. At convergence, the worked case of a particularly vulnerable tribal household needing forest rights, tribal mission infrastructure, the school meal programme, the integrated nutrition programme, health assurance

and an old-age pension shows six ministries, six databases and six reporting lines meeting at one door, and the district collector who is notionally responsible lacks real-time data and authority over central implementing agencies. At outcome, the sixth round of the family health survey covering 2023-24 and released on 29 May 2026 records under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, which establishes both that progress is real and that a substantial deficit persists behind high administrative enrolment. At correction, the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and the finance ministry's output-outcome monitoring framework exist, yet findings remain in reports because allocation does not depend on verified outcome improvement. Where the proposition is strongest: participation operates at precisely the two points the architecture leaves weakest, uptake and correction, because a community that knows its entitlement supplies the demand-side pressure that a fragmented frontline cannot, and community monitoring and social audit surface exclusions that no dashboard reports; the district-convergence experience shows that indicator-led attention improves measured performance, and it equally shows that ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, which is exactly the distortion informed local scrutiny is placed to catch. Where it is insufficient: awareness cannot repair a stale eligibility list, cannot align disbursement cycles, cannot confer authority on a collector and cannot make evaluation binding on the budget; and the Economic Survey of 2025-26 records that cash transfers improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits where complementary public services and work opportunities are absent, which shows a fully delivered and fully known benefit still failing on outcome. Qualification: participation must also be real rather than procedural, because consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and it must be paired with an assisted, non-digital correction route, since the households least aware of their entitlements are usually the same households whose records are wrong. Verdict: agree with the proposition as a diagnosis of the uptake and correction stages, qualify it as incomplete for the targeting, convergence and evaluation stages, and conclude that awareness and involvement should be institutionalised as a statutory participation and social-audit requirement inside the cycle rather than added to it as a campaign. Why this earns marks: it accepts the examiner's causal claim explicitly, locates it precisely within a named five-stage architecture, supplies dated official evidence including the survey round and the Economic Survey finding, and closes with a qualified verdict rather than a general appeal for greater public awareness.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 General Studies Paper II", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the demand contains an embedded causal assertion, that ineffectiveness is due to the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the mark-bearing answer is one that agrees with participation as a real and underweighted cause while showing that it is one link in a five-stage cycle whose other links fail independently, so participation is necessary and not sufficient. Named evidence and analysis, stage by stage. At targeting, the deprivation database of 2011 is over a decade old, documentation proxies for identity rather than need, and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for consumption poverty; a household excluded here is excluded before any question of awareness arises, which is why an awareness campaign cannot reach a person the list does not contain. At delivery, the transfer rail, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement move money reliably while the frontline cadres, the auxiliary nurse midwife, the health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, each serve one scheme and hold no household-wide view, so the person best placed to inform a family about a second entitlement has no institutional reason to know of it. At convergence, the worked case of a particularly vulnerable tribal household needing forest rights, tribal mission infrastructure, the school meal programme, the integrated nutrition programme, health assurance and an old-age pension shows six ministries, six databases and six reporting lines meeting at one door, and the district collector who is notionally responsible lacks real-time data and authority over central implementing agencies. At outcome, the sixth round of the family health survey covering 2023-24 and released on 29 May 2026 records under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, which establishes both that progress is real and that a substantial deficit persists behind high administrative enrolment. At correction, the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and the finance ministry's output-outcome monitoring framework exist, yet findings remain in reports because allocation does not depend on verified outcome improvement. Where the proposition is strongest: participation operates at precisely the two points the architecture leaves weakest, uptake and

correction, because a community that knows its entitlement supplies the demand-side pressure that a fragmented frontline cannot, and community monitoring and social audit surface exclusions that no dashboard reports; the district-convergence experience shows that indicator-led attention improves measured performance, and it equally shows that ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, which is exactly the distortion informed local scrutiny is placed to catch. Where it is insufficient: awareness cannot repair a stale eligibility list, cannot align disbursement cycles, cannot confer authority on a collector and cannot make evaluation binding on the budget; and the Economic Survey of 2025-26 records that cash transfers improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits where complementary public services and work opportunities are absent, which shows a fully delivered and fully known benefit still failing on outcome. Qualification: participation must also be real rather than procedural, because consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and it must be paired with an assisted, non-digital correction route, since the households least aware of their entitlements are usually the same households whose records are wrong. Verdict: agree with the proposition as a diagnosis of the uptake and correction stages, qualify it as incomplete for the targeting, convergence and evaluation stages, and conclude that awareness and involvement should be institutionalised as a statutory participation and social-audit requirement inside the cycle rather than added to it as a campaign. Why this earns marks: it accepts the examiner's causal claim explicitly, locates it precisely within a named five-stage architecture, supplies dated official evidence including the survey round and the Economic Survey finding, and closes with a qualified verdict rather than a general appeal for greater public awareness.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 General Studies Paper II **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the demand contains an embedded causal assertion, that ineffectiveness is due to the absence of awareness and active involvement, and the mark-bearing answer is one that agrees with participation as a real and underweighted cause while showing that it is one link in a five-stage cycle whose other links fail independently, so participation is necessary and not sufficient. Named evidence and analysis, stage by stage. At targeting, the deprivation database of 2011 is over a decade old, documentation proxies for identity rather than need, and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for consumption poverty; a household excluded here is excluded before any question of awareness arises, which is why an awareness campaign cannot reach a person the list does not contain. At delivery, the transfer rail, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement move money reliably while the frontline cadres, the auxiliary nurse midwife, the health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, each serve one scheme and hold no household-wide view, so the person best placed to inform a family about a second entitlement has no institutional reason to know of it. At convergence, the worked case of a particularly vulnerable tribal household needing forest rights, tribal mission infrastructure, the school meal programme, the integrated nutrition programme, health assurance and an old-age pension shows six ministries, six databases and six reporting lines meeting at one door, and the district collector who is notionally responsible lacks real-time data and authority over central implementing agencies. At outcome, the sixth round of the family health survey covering 2023-24 and released on 29 May 2026 records under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, which establishes both that progress is real and that a substantial deficit persists behind high administrative enrolment. At correction, the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and the finance ministry's output-outcome monitoring framework exist, yet findings remain in reports because allocation does not depend on verified outcome improvement. Where the proposition is strongest: participation operates at precisely the two points the architecture leaves weakest, uptake and correction, because a community that knows its entitlement supplies the demand-side pressure that a fragmented frontline cannot, and community monitoring and social audit surface exclusions that no dashboard reports; the district-convergence experience shows that indicator-led attention improves measured performance, and it equally

shows that ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, which is exactly the distortion informed local scrutiny is placed to catch. Where it is insufficient: awareness cannot repair a stale eligibility list, cannot align disbursement cycles, cannot confer authority on a collector and cannot make evaluation binding on the budget; and the Economic Survey of 2025-26 records that cash transfers improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits where complementary public services and work opportunities are absent, which shows a fully delivered and fully known benefit still failing on outcome. Qualification: participation must also be real rather than procedural, because consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and it must be paired with an assisted, non-digital correction route, since the households least aware of their entitlements are usually the same households whose records are wrong. Verdict: agree with the proposition as a diagnosis of the uptake and correction stages, qualify it as incomplete for the targeting, convergence and evaluation stages, and conclude that awareness and involvement should be institutionalised as a statutory participation and social-audit requirement inside the cycle rather than added to it as a campaign. Why this earns marks: it accepts the examiner's causal claim explicitly, locates it precisely within a named five-stage architecture, supplies dated official evidence including the survey round and the Economic Survey finding, and closes with a qualified verdict rather than a general appeal for greater public awareness.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 General Studies Paper II", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 General Studies Paper II

Demand: Development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by its nature, are discriminatory in approach. Do you agree? Give reasons for your answer, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger and as printed in the locally held official question paper.

Status: Routed to this owner by the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger with the recorded note that this core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and recorded in the Basic owner's answer architecture as an ownership held here. The printed wording was confirmed against the locally held official General Studies Paper II of 2023; no official answer key, marking scheme or model answer is claimed from that paper, and the solution below is original.

Model solution: Claim: agree in the descriptive sense and disagree in the pejorative sense, because targeted schemes are necessarily discriminatory in the literal meaning of drawing distinctions between persons, and that differentiation is constitutionally and analytically justified as compensatory rather than arbitrary; the answer must nonetheless concede that specific design and delivery choices convert justified differentiation into unjustified exclusion. Named evidence and reasoning in three movements. First, why differentiation is inherent and defensible: targeting concentrates limited resources by identifying who is eligible, and the two targeting errors are structurally opposed, since inclusion error means an ineligible person receives a benefit while exclusion error means an eligible person is denied one, so any rule tight enough to prevent leakage will exclude some genuine claimants; universal provision such as the food-security law covering roughly two-thirds of the population minimises exclusion at higher cost and with some inclusion of the non-poor, while a targeted scheme such as the health-assurance route built on the deprivation database concentrates resources at the cost of documentation burden, and the same scheme also carries a universal age-based route for all persons aged seventy and above, which demonstrates that the choice is programme-specific rather than ideological. The differentiation is compensatory because the deprivations differ in kind: the social-assistance umbrella pays an old-age, widow or disability pension, a lump sum on a breadwinner's death and food support for uncovered elderly persons, and these are five different answers to five different contingencies rather than one benefit unequally distributed. Second, where the charge lands: the discrimination becomes objectionable when it is arbitrary in operation rather than in intent, and the owners locate that arbitrariness precisely. The deprivation database dates from 2011, so the newly poor are excluded by vintage; documentation proxies for identity rather than for need, so a household without an identity number, ration card or caste certificate is excluded by paperwork; deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for

consumption poverty, so both inclusion and exclusion errors survive careful administration; and a land-record mismatch can exclude an otherwise enrolled household from cultivator income support without any decision being taken about it. Convergence failure compounds the effect, because six ministries with six databases and six frontline cadres meeting at one household ration access by administrative accident rather than by need. Third, the constitutional and evidential limits: the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards, and verification must not become denial of the entitlement, which supplies the standard against which a targeting rule should be tested; and the Economic Survey of 2025-26 records that transfers improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving nutrition, education or durable poverty exits where complementary services are absent, which shows that even a correctly targeted benefit can leave the underlying disadvantage in place. Qualification and verdict: agree that these schemes discriminate in the sense of differentiating, hold that such differentiation is justified where it is compensatory, evidence-based, currently verified and correctable, and hold that it becomes indefensible where the evidence is stale, the documents substitute for need, the correction route is absent or the outcome is never measured; the corrective is therefore a purpose-limited and updated interoperability layer with human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access, together with outcome measurement that keeps its survey round attached, rather than abandonment of targeting itself. Why this earns marks: it takes an explicit position on a proposition the examiner has framed to invite an unqualified yes or no, distinguishes two senses of the operative word, supplies named schemes, named error types and dated official evidence for each movement, and converts the concession into a specific institutional remedy instead of ending in balance for its own sake.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 General Studies Paper II”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: agree in the descriptive sense and disagree in the pejorative sense, because targeted schemes are necessarily discriminatory in the literal meaning of drawing distinctions between persons, and that differentiation is constitutionally and analytically justified as compensatory rather than arbitrary; the answer must nonetheless concede that specific design and delivery choices convert justified differentiation into unjustified exclusion. Named evidence and reasoning in three movements. First, why differentiation is inherent and defensible: targeting concentrates limited resources by identifying who is eligible, and the two targeting errors are structurally opposed, since inclusion error means an ineligible person receives a benefit while exclusion error means an eligible person is denied one, so any rule tight enough to prevent leakage will exclude some genuine claimants; universal provision such as the food-security law covering roughly two-thirds of the population minimises exclusion at higher cost and with some inclusion of the non-poor, while a targeted scheme such as the health-assurance route built on the deprivation database concentrates resources at the cost of documentation burden, and the same scheme also carries a universal age-based route for all persons aged seventy and above, which demonstrates that the choice is programme-specific rather than ideological. The differentiation is compensatory because the deprivations differ in kind: the social-assistance umbrella pays an old-age, widow or disability pension, a lump sum on a breadwinner's death and food support for uncovered elderly persons, and these are five different answers to five different contingencies rather than one benefit unequally distributed. Second, where the charge lands: the discrimination becomes objectionable when it is arbitrary in operation rather than in intent, and the owners locate that arbitrariness precisely. The deprivation database dates from 2011, so the newly poor are excluded by vintage; documentation proxies for identity rather than for need, so a household without an identity number, ration card or caste certificate is excluded by paperwork; deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for consumption poverty, so both inclusion and exclusion errors survive careful administration; and a land-record mismatch can exclude an otherwise enrolled household from cultivator income support without any decision being taken about it. Convergence failure compounds the effect, because six ministries with six databases and six frontline cadres meeting at one household ration access by administrative accident rather than by need. Third, the constitutional and evidential limits: the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards, and verification must not become denial of the entitlement, which supplies the standard against which a targeting rule should be tested; and the Economic Survey of 2025-26 records that transfers improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving nutrition, education or durable poverty exits where complementary services are absent, which shows that even a correctly targeted benefit can leave the underlying disadvantage in

place. Qualification and verdict: agree that these schemes discriminate in the sense of differentiating, hold that such differentiation is justified where it is compensatory, evidence-based, currently verified and correctable, and hold that it becomes indefensible where the evidence is stale, the documents substitute for need, the correction route is absent or the outcome is never measured; the corrective is therefore a purpose-limited and updated interoperability layer with human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access, together with outcome measurement that keeps its survey round attached, rather than abandonment of targeting itself. Why this earns marks: it takes an explicit position on a proposition the examiner has framed to invite an unqualified yes or no, distinguishes two senses of the operative word, supplies named schemes, named error types and dated official evidence for each movement, and converts the concession into a specific institutional remedy instead of ending in balance for its own sake.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 General Studies Paper II **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: agree in the descriptive sense and disagree in the pejorative sense, because targeted schemes are necessarily discriminatory in the literal meaning of drawing distinctions between persons, and that differentiation is constitutionally and analytically justified as compensatory rather than arbitrary; the answer must nonetheless concede that specific design and delivery choices convert justified differentiation into unjustified exclusion. Named evidence and reasoning in three movements. First, why differentiation is inherent and defensible: targeting concentrates limited resources by identifying who is eligible, and the two targeting errors are structurally opposed, since inclusion error means an ineligible person receives a benefit while exclusion error means an eligible person is denied one, so any rule tight enough to prevent leakage will exclude some genuine claimants; universal provision such as the food-security law covering roughly two-thirds of the population minimises exclusion at higher cost and with some inclusion of the non-poor, while a targeted scheme such as the health-assurance route built on the deprivation database concentrates resources at the cost of documentation burden, and the same scheme also carries a universal age-based route for all persons aged seventy and above, which demonstrates that the choice is programme-specific rather than ideological. The differentiation is compensatory because the deprivations differ in kind: the social-assistance umbrella pays an old-age, widow or disability pension, a lump sum on a breadwinner's death and food support for uncovered elderly persons, and these are five different answers to five different contingencies rather than one benefit unequally distributed. Second, where the charge lands: the discrimination becomes objectionable when it is arbitrary in operation rather than in intent, and the owners locate that arbitrariness precisely. The deprivation database dates from 2011, so the newly poor are excluded by vintage; documentation proxies for identity rather than for need, so a household without an identity number, ration card or caste certificate is excluded by paperwork; deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for consumption poverty, so both inclusion and exclusion errors survive careful administration; and a land-record mismatch can exclude an otherwise enrolled household from cultivator income support without any decision being taken about it. Convergence failure compounds the effect, because six ministries with six databases and six frontline cadres meeting at one household ration access by administrative accident rather than by need. Third, the constitutional and evidential limits: the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards, and verification must not become denial of the entitlement, which supplies the standard against which a targeting rule should be tested; and the Economic Survey of 2025-26 records that transfers improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving nutrition, education or durable poverty exits where complementary services are absent, which shows that even a correctly targeted benefit can leave the underlying disadvantage in place. Qualification and verdict: agree that these schemes discriminate in the sense of differentiating, hold that such differentiation is justified where it is compensatory, evidence-based, currently verified and correctable, and hold that it becomes indefensible where the evidence is stale, the documents substitute for need, the correction route is absent or the outcome is never measured; the corrective is therefore a purpose-limited and updated interoperability layer with

human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access, together with outcome measurement that keeps its survey round attached, rather than abandonment of targeting itself. Why this earns marks: it takes an explicit position on a proposition the examiner has framed to invite an unqualified yes or no, distinguishes two senses of the operative word, supplies named schemes, named error types and dated official evidence for each movement, and converts the concession into a specific institutional remedy instead of ending in balance for its own sake.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 General Studies Paper II", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish inclusion error from exclusion error in social-sector targeting, and explain how a deprivation-based targeting database affects each. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: the two errors move in opposite directions under any given verification rule, so a targeting database does not reduce error in general but chooses which error the programme will bear. Named evidence: inclusion error defined as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor and exclusion error as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the needy miss benefits; the 2011 targeting database built on deprivation and occupation indicators including housing type, land and assets and distinct in purpose and methodology from the decennial Census; its use as the core eligibility route of the health-assurance scheme alongside a separate age-based route for persons aged seventy and above; and the recorded limits that the database is over a decade old, that documentation proxies for identity rather than need, and that deprivation criteria are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty. Analysis: a deprivation-based list reduces the inclusion error that a self-declared list would produce, while its vintage and its document requirements generate exclusion error among the newly poor and the undocumented, so the database converts a leakage problem into an exclusion problem rather than solving both. Qualification: the answer should record that the choice is defensible where the benefit is costly and rationed, and should require an assisted correction route as the price of using a dated list.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use.
- The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making.
- The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above.
- The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are

excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the two errors move in opposite directions under any given verification rule, so a targeting database does not reduce error in general but chooses which error the programme will bear. Named evidence: inclusion error defined as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor and exclusion error as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the needy miss benefits; the 2011 targeting database built on deprivation and occupation indicators including housing type, land and assets and distinct in purpose and methodology from the decennial Census; its use as the core eligibility route of the health-assurance scheme alongside a separate age-based route for persons aged seventy and above; and the recorded limits that the database is over a decade old, that documentation proxies for identity rather than need, and that deprivation criteria are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty. Analysis: a deprivation-based list reduces the inclusion error that a self-declared list would produce, while its vintage and its document requirements generate exclusion error among the newly poor and the undocumented, so the database converts a leakage problem into an exclusion problem rather than solving both. Qualification: the answer should record that the choice is defensible where the benefit is costly and rationed, and should require an assisted correction route as the price of using a dated list.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Distinguish inclusion error from exclusion error in social-sector targeting, and explain how...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the two errors move in opposite directions under any given verification rule, so a targeting database does not reduce error in general but chooses which error the programme will bear. Named evidence: inclusion error defined as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor and exclusion error as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the needy miss benefits; the 2011 targeting database built on deprivation and occupation indicators including housing type, land and assets and distinct in purpose and methodology from the decennial Census; its use as the core eligibility route of the health-assurance scheme alongside a separate age-based route for persons aged seventy and above; and the recorded limits that the database is over a decade old, that documentation proxies for identity rather than need, and that deprivation criteria are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty. Analysis: a deprivation-based list reduces the inclusion error that a self-declared list would produce, while its vintage and its document requirements generate exclusion error among the newly poor and the undocumented, so the database converts a leakage problem into an exclusion problem rather than solving both. Qualification: the answer should record that the choice is defensible where the benefit is costly and rationed, and should require an assisted correction route as the price of using a dated list.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners define inclusion error, also called Type I error, as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor, and exclusion error, also called Type II error, as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the truly needy miss benefits. The examinable point is that the two errors

trade against each other rather than rising and falling together, so tightening verification to reduce leakage raises exclusion among genuine claimants who lack documents, and an answer that treats both as symptoms of poor administration has missed the structural choice that scheme design is actually making. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners set the trade-off out with its instruments named. Universal provision under the food-security law covers roughly two-thirds of the population and reduces exclusion error while including some non-poor and costing more; targeted provision such as the health-assurance scheme concentrates resources but raises exclusion risk and documentation burden. They record that there is no first-best answer and that the optimal mix depends on the programme type, and they record the complication that a single scheme can carry both logics at once, since the health-assurance scheme runs a deprivation-targeted core route alongside a universal age-based route for persons aged seventy and above. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the two errors move in opposite directions under any given verification rule, so a targeting database does not reduce error in general but chooses which error the programme will bear. Named evidence: inclusion error defined as the inclusion of ineligible beneficiaries so that resources leak to the non-poor and exclusion error as the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries so that the needy miss benefits; the 2011 targeting database built on deprivation and occupation indicators including housing type, land and assets and distinct in purpose and methodology from the decennial Census; its use as the core eligibility route of the health-assurance scheme alongside a separate age-based route for persons aged seventy and above; and the recorded limits that the database is over a decade old, that documentation proxies for identity rather than need, and that deprivation criteria are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty. Analysis: a deprivation-based list reduces the inclusion error that a self-declared list would produce, while its vintage and its document requirements generate exclusion error among the newly poor and the undocumented, so the database converts a leakage problem into an exclusion problem rather than solving both. Qualification: the answer should record that the choice is defensible where the benefit is costly and rationed, and should require an assisted correction route as the price of using a dated list.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish inclusion error from exclusion error in social-sector targeting, and explain how...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why high administrative coverage does not establish that a social-sector scheme has succeeded. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: coverage and capability are measured by different instruments at different levels of result, so a coverage figure cannot answer a capability question however large it is. Named evidence: the distinction between output as the immediate product, outcome as the medium-term change and impact as the long-term capability, with administrative data capturing outputs, surveys capturing outcomes and evaluations estimating impact; the distinction between administrative data that is high frequency and excludes the non-enrolled, survey data that is comparable but sampled and lagged, and census data that is universal but infrequent; the sixth round of the family health survey covering 2023-24 and released on 29 May 2026 reporting under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent against 35.5 per cent in the fifth round; and the boundary case of a State with high integrated child development enrolment that lags on anaemia reduction. Analysis: the divergence between a dashboard and a survey is itself the finding, because it locates the failure in service quality and convergence rather than in enrolment, and investigating it is the step the outcome-learning chain records as missing. Qualification: the answer should concede that improvement is real and measurable, since stunting fell between the two rounds, while insisting that the round travel with the figure.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation.
- The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism.
- The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged.
- The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: coverage and capability are measured by different instruments at different levels of result, so a coverage figure cannot answer a capability question however large it is. Named evidence: the distinction between output as the immediate product, outcome as the medium-term change and impact as the long-term

capability, with administrative data capturing outputs, surveys capturing outcomes and evaluations estimating impact; the distinction between administrative data that is high frequency and excludes the non-enrolled, survey data that is comparable but sampled and lagged, and census data that is universal but infrequent; the sixth round of the family health survey covering 2023-24 and released on 29 May 2026 reporting under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent against 35.5 per cent in the fifth round; and the boundary case of a State with high integrated child development enrolment that lags on anaemia reduction. Analysis: the divergence between a dashboard and a survey is itself the finding, because it locates the failure in service quality and convergence rather than in enrolment, and investigating it is the step the outcome-learning chain records as missing. Qualification: the answer should concede that improvement is real and measurable, since stunting fell between the two rounds, while insisting that the round travel with the figure.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Explain why high administrative coverage does not establish that a social-sector scheme has...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: coverage and capability are measured by different instruments at different levels of result, so a coverage figure cannot answer a capability question however large it is. Named evidence: the distinction between output as the immediate product, outcome as the medium-term change and impact as the long-term capability, with administrative data capturing outputs, surveys capturing outcomes and evaluations estimating impact; the distinction between administrative data that is high frequency and excludes the non-enrolled, survey data that is comparable but sampled and lagged, and census data that is universal but infrequent; the sixth round of the family health survey covering 2023-24 and released on 29 May 2026 reporting under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent against 35.5 per cent in the fifth round; and the boundary case of a State with high integrated child development enrolment that lags on anaemia reduction. Analysis: the divergence between a dashboard and a survey is itself the finding, because it locates the failure in service quality and convergence rather than in enrolment, and investigating it is the step the outcome-learning chain records as missing. Qualification: the answer should concede that improvement is real and measurable, since stunting fell between the two rounds, while insisting that the round travel with the figure.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development

Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: coverage and capability are measured by different instruments at different levels of result, so a coverage figure cannot answer a capability question however large it is. Named evidence: the distinction between output as the immediate product, outcome as the medium-term change and impact as the long-term capability, with administrative data capturing outputs, surveys capturing outcomes and evaluations estimating impact; the distinction between administrative data that is high frequency and excludes the non-enrolled, survey data that is comparable but sampled and lagged, and census data that is universal but infrequent; the sixth round of the family health survey covering 2023-24 and released on 29 May 2026 reporting under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent against 35.5 per cent in the fifth round; and the boundary case of a State with high integrated child development enrolment that lags on anaemia reduction. Analysis: the divergence between a dashboard and a survey is itself the finding, because it locates the failure in service quality and convergence rather than in enrolment, and investigating it is the step the outcome-learning chain records as missing. Qualification: the answer should concede that improvement is real and measurable, since stunting fell between the two rounds, while insisting that the round travel with the figure.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain why high administrative coverage does not establish that a social-sector scheme has...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Critically examine the claim that India's social-sector schemes suffer from a convergence deficit at the household level. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: the claim is sustained, and the deficit is architectural rather than attitudinal, because deprivation is simultaneous while the administrative system is organised by scheme. Named evidence: convergence defined as coordination of multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for one household, with horizontal coordination across ministries and vertical coordination across the Centre, State, district and block both required; the worked case of a particularly vulnerable tribal household needing forest rights, tribal mission infrastructure, the school meal programme, the integrated nutrition programme, health assurance and a social-assistance pension, each from a different ministry with a different eligibility database and frontline worker; the four-step failure chain of siloed eligibility databases, fragmented frontline cadres, district collectors without real-time data or authority over central implementing agencies, and mismatched disbursement cycles; and the boundary cases of a land-record mismatch excluding a household from cultivator income support and a hamlet with housing sanction but persistent malnutrition. Analysis: each failure has a distinct corrective, an interoperability layer for databases, a household-wide view for the frontline, statutory convergence authority for the district and cycle alignment for timing, so a general call for better coordination cannot repair any of them. Qualification: the examination should record that indicator-led district convergence has been demonstrated but can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, and that interoperability carries privacy and profiling risks requiring purpose limitation and correction rights.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis.
- The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line.
- The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not.
- The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it.
- The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which

incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the claim is sustained, and the deficit is architectural rather than attitudinal, because deprivation is simultaneous while the administrative system is organised by scheme. Named evidence: convergence defined as coordination of multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for one household, with horizontal coordination across ministries and vertical coordination across the Centre, State, district and block both required; the worked case of a particularly vulnerable tribal household needing forest rights, tribal mission infrastructure, the school meal programme, the integrated nutrition programme, health assurance and a social-assistance pension, each from a different ministry with a different eligibility database and frontline worker; the four-step failure chain of siloed eligibility databases, fragmented frontline cadres, district collectors without real-time data or authority over central implementing agencies, and mismatched disbursement cycles; and the boundary cases of a land-record mismatch excluding a household from cultivator income support and a hamlet with housing sanction but persistent malnutrition. Analysis: each failure has a distinct corrective, an interoperability layer for databases, a household-wide view for the frontline, statutory convergence authority for the district and cycle alignment for timing, so a general call for better coordination cannot repair any of them. Qualification: the examination should record that indicator-led district convergence has been demonstrated but can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, and that interoperability carries privacy and profiling risks requiring purpose limitation and correction rights.

Demand decoding: The directive **critically examine** requires a direct position on “Critically examine the claim that India's social-sector schemes suffer from a convergence...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the claim is sustained, and the deficit is architectural rather than attitudinal, because deprivation is simultaneous while the administrative system is organised by scheme. Named evidence: convergence defined as coordination of multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for one household, with horizontal coordination across ministries and vertical coordination across the Centre, State, district and block both required; the worked case of a particularly vulnerable tribal household needing forest rights, tribal mission infrastructure, the school meal programme, the integrated nutrition programme, health assurance and a social-assistance pension, each from a different ministry with a different eligibility database and frontline worker; the four-step failure chain of siloed eligibility databases, fragmented frontline cadres, district collectors without real-time data or authority over central implementing agencies, and mismatched disbursement cycles; and the boundary cases of a land-record mismatch excluding a household from cultivator income support and a hamlet with housing sanction but persistent malnutrition. Analysis: each failure has a distinct corrective, an interoperability layer for databases, a household-wide view for the frontline, statutory convergence authority for the district and cycle alignment for timing, so a general call for better coordination cannot repair any of them. Qualification: the examination should record that indicator-led district convergence has been demonstrated but can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, and that interoperability carries privacy and profiling risks requiring purpose limitation and correction rights.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners define convergence as the administrative challenge of coordinating multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for a single beneficiary or household, and they record it as critical for multi-dimensional poverty because deprivation is simultaneous while schemes are sequential. They distinguish horizontal convergence, meaning coordination across ministries at the same level, from vertical convergence, meaning coordination across the Centre, the State, the district and the block, and they record that both are necessary for household-level convergence, so an answer that proposes only an inter-ministerial committee has addressed one axis. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.

Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners give a worked convergence case rather than an abstraction. A particularly vulnerable tribal group household in a remote block may simultaneously need individual and community forest rights under the forest-rights law administered by the tribal affairs ministry and the State forest department, housing, road and water support under the tribal development mission of the same ministry, the school meal programme of the education ministry, the integrated nutrition programme of the women and child development ministry, health assurance through the national health authority and a social-assistance pension for an elderly member from the rural development ministry. The owners record that each scheme has a different eligibility database, a different frontline worker and a different reporting line. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners give three boundary cases that convert the failure chain into diagnosable situations. A household enrolled in food security, health assurance and social assistance but excluded from the income-support scheme for cultivators because of a land-record mismatch illustrates database fragmentation. A hamlet of a particularly vulnerable tribal group with near-universal housing sanction under the tribal mission but persistent malnutrition recorded in survey data illustrates the output-outcome gap. A State that achieves high integrated child development enrolment but lags on anaemia reduction illustrates the convergence-quality gap, in which enrolment occurs without service quality behind it. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the claim is sustained, and the deficit is architectural rather than attitudinal, because deprivation is simultaneous while the administrative system is organised by scheme. Named evidence: convergence defined as coordination of multiple ministries and schemes at the point of delivery for one household, with horizontal coordination across ministries and vertical coordination across the Centre, State, district and block both required; the worked case of a particularly vulnerable tribal household needing forest rights, tribal mission infrastructure, the school meal programme, the integrated nutrition programme, health assurance and a social-assistance pension, each from a different ministry with a different eligibility database and frontline worker; the four-step failure chain of siloed eligibility databases, fragmented frontline cadres, district collectors without real-time data or authority over central implementing agencies, and mismatched disbursement cycles; and the boundary cases of a land-record mismatch excluding a household from cultivator income support and a hamlet with housing sanction but persistent malnutrition. Analysis: each failure has a distinct corrective, an interoperability layer for databases, a household-wide view for the frontline, statutory convergence authority for the district and cycle alignment for timing, so a general call for better coordination cannot repair any of them. Qualification: the examination should record that indicator-led district convergence has been demonstrated but can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, and that interoperability carries privacy and profiling risks requiring purpose limitation and correction rights.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Critically examine the claim that India's social-sector schemes suffer from a convergence...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess whether India's social-sector data architecture is capable of correcting the schemes it measures. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: the architecture can detect failure and cannot yet convert detection into redesign, so its weakness lies in the feedback link rather than in measurement capacity. Named evidence: the outcome instruments comprising the family health survey, the labour force survey, the crime records data, the composite goal index and the multidimensional poverty measure; the three-step outcome-learning failure chain of uninvestigated dashboard-survey divergence, evaluation findings that remain in reports, and a political preference for announceable coverage figures over unflattering outcome figures; the evaluation office housed in the national policy think tank coordinating third-party evaluations and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement; the static 2011 targeting database; and the 2027 caste enumeration approved on 30 April 2025 with first-phase houselisting notified from 1 April to 30 September 2026 and no results available. Analysis: the measurement layer is comparatively strong and the correction layer is institutionally weak, because the budget framework requires outcome statements without making allocation depend on verified outcome improvement, which leaves evaluation advisory in a system where funding is the only binding signal. Qualification: the assessment should record that outcome-linked allocation may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations and that the pending enumeration is an operation rather than a database, so neither is a complete remedy.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent,

improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged.

- The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement.
- The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap.
- The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use.
- The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the architecture can detect failure and cannot yet convert detection into redesign, so its weakness lies in the feedback link rather than in measurement capacity. Named evidence: the outcome instruments comprising the family health survey, the labour force survey, the crime records data, the composite goal index and the multidimensional poverty measure; the three-step outcome-learning failure chain of uninvestigated dashboard-survey divergence, evaluation findings that remain in reports, and a political preference for announceable coverage figures over unflattering outcome figures; the evaluation office housed in the national policy think tank coordinating third-party evaluations and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement; the static 2011 targeting database; and the 2027 caste enumeration approved on 30 April 2025 with first-phase houselisting notified from 1 April to 30 September 2026 and no results available. Analysis: the measurement layer is comparatively strong and the correction layer is institutionally weak, because the budget framework requires outcome statements without making allocation depend on verified outcome improvement, which leaves evaluation advisory in a system where funding is the only binding signal. Qualification: the assessment should record that outcome-linked allocation may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations and that the pending enumeration is an operation rather than a database, so neither is a complete remedy.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess whether India's social-sector data architecture is capable of correcting the schemes...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the architecture can detect failure and cannot yet convert detection into redesign, so its weakness lies in the feedback link rather than in measurement capacity. Named evidence: the outcome instruments comprising the family health survey, the labour force survey, the crime records data, the composite goal index and the multidimensional poverty measure; the three-step outcome-learning failure chain of uninvestigated dashboard-survey divergence, evaluation findings that remain in reports, and a political preference for announceable coverage figures over unflattering outcome figures; the evaluation office housed in the national policy think tank coordinating third-party evaluations and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement; the static 2011 targeting database; and the 2027 caste enumeration approved on 30 April 2025 with first-phase houselisting notified from 1 April to 30 September 2026 and no results available. Analysis: the measurement layer is comparatively strong and the correction layer is institutionally weak, because the budget framework requires outcome statements without making allocation depend on verified outcome improvement, which leaves evaluation advisory in a system where funding is the only binding signal. Qualification: the assessment should record that outcome-linked allocation may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations and that the pending enumeration is an operation rather than a database, so neither is a complete remedy.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the caste-enumeration decision precisely and bound it. The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs approved caste enumeration for the 2027 Census on 30 April 2025, and first-phase houselisting is notified for the period from 1 April to 30 September 2026, so operations have begun but no results are available as at the recorded status date. They instruct that this is an ongoing operation rather than a published database or a ready-made targeting list, and they record that a database update would improve targeting but is a massive logistical exercise, so the 2027 enumeration may only partially address the data-architecture gap. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the Socio-Economic and Caste Census of 2011 as a targeting database distinct from the decennial Census, built on deprivation and occupation indicators such as housing type, land and assets, and they record that its rural and urban deprivation data underpins the core eligibility route of the national health-assurance scheme while the separate route covering all persons aged seventy and above is

age-based and not limited by that database. They record two boundaries that objective questions test: the two exercises differ in purpose and methodology, and the caste data collected in 2011 was not released or validated for general policy use. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the architecture can detect failure and cannot yet convert detection into redesign, so its weakness lies in the feedback link rather than in measurement capacity. Named evidence: the outcome instruments comprising the family health survey, the labour force survey, the crime records data, the composite goal index and the multidimensional poverty measure; the three-step outcome-learning failure chain of uninvestigated dashboard-survey divergence, evaluation findings that remain in reports, and a political preference for announceable coverage figures over unflattering outcome figures; the evaluation office housed in the national policy think tank coordinating third-party evaluations and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement; the static 2011 targeting database; and the 2027 caste enumeration approved on 30 April 2025 with first-phase houselisting notified from 1 April to 30 September 2026 and no results available. Analysis: the measurement layer is comparatively strong and the correction layer is institutionally weak, because the budget framework requires outcome statements without making allocation depend on verified outcome improvement, which leaves evaluation advisory in a system where funding is the only binding signal. Qualification: the assessment should record that outcome-linked allocation may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations and that the pending enumeration is an operation rather than a database, so neither is a complete remedy.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess whether India's social-sector data architecture is capable of correcting the schemes...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Analyse the complete cycle from targeting to correction and evaluate where India's social-sector performance is actually constrained. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: the binding constraint moves as one travels the cycle, sitting in database vintage at targeting, in cadre fragmentation at convergence and in the absence of a funding consequence at correction, so a single reform aimed at any one stage cannot lift performance overall. Named evidence: the five-stage cycle of targeting, delivery, convergence, outcome measurement and correction with the rule that no component substitutes for another; the five-component social-assistance umbrella with fixed central assistance and State top-ups; the 2011 deprivation database with its unreleased caste data and its use alongside an age-based health route; the delivery layer of direct benefit transfer with the identity, account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system, the single nodal agency arrangement and the frontline cadres; the convergence failure chain and its worked tribal-household case; the three data types and the three result levels; the sixth family health survey round of 2023-24 released on 29 May 2026 with stunting at 29.3 per cent against 35.5 per cent; the evaluation office and the output-outcome budget framework; and the Economic Survey finding that transfers improve consumption and food security without consistently improving nutrition, education or durable poverty exit where complementary services are absent. Analysis: the survey finding is decisive because it shows the delivery stage working while the outcome stage does not, which locates the constraint in what surrounds the transfer rather than in the transfer itself, and the correction stage then fails to act on that finding because allocation does not depend on it. Qualification: the analysis should concede genuine progress in delivery and in stunting reduction, should keep every figure with its round or status date, and should treat the 2027 enumeration as pending rather than as a solution already available.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole.
- The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list.
- The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements.
- The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not.
- The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and

evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism.

- The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged.
- The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support.
- The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the binding constraint moves as one travels the cycle, sitting in database vintage at targeting, in cadre fragmentation at convergence and in the absence of a funding consequence at correction, so a single reform aimed at any one stage cannot lift performance overall. Named evidence: the five-stage cycle of targeting, delivery, convergence, outcome measurement and correction with the rule that no component substitutes for another; the five-component social-assistance umbrella with fixed central assistance and State top-ups; the 2011 deprivation database with its unreleased caste data and its use alongside an age-based health route; the delivery layer of direct benefit transfer with the identity, account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system, the single nodal agency arrangement and the frontline cadres; the convergence failure chain and its worked tribal-household case; the three data types and the three result levels; the sixth family health survey round of 2023-24 released on 29 May 2026 with stunting at 29.3 per cent against 35.5 per cent; the evaluation office and the output-outcome budget framework; and the Economic Survey finding that transfers improve consumption and food security without consistently improving nutrition, education or durable poverty exit where complementary services are absent. Analysis: the survey finding is decisive because it shows the delivery stage working while the outcome stage does not, which locates the constraint in what surrounds the transfer rather than in the transfer itself, and the correction stage then fails to act on that finding because allocation does not depend on it. Qualification: the analysis should concede genuine progress in delivery and in stunting reduction, should keep every figure with its round or status date, and should treat the 2027 enumeration as pending rather than as a solution already available.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on “Analyse the complete cycle from targeting to correction and evaluate where India’s social-...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the binding constraint moves as one travels the cycle, sitting in database vintage at targeting, in cadre fragmentation at convergence and in the absence of a funding consequence at correction, so a single reform aimed at any one stage cannot lift performance overall. Named evidence: the five-stage cycle of

targeting, delivery, convergence, outcome measurement and correction with the rule that no component substitutes for another; the five-component social-assistance umbrella with fixed central assistance and State top-ups; the 2011 deprivation database with its unreleased caste data and its use alongside an age-based health route; the delivery layer of direct benefit transfer with the identity, account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system, the single nodal agency arrangement and the frontline cadres; the convergence failure chain and its worked tribal-household case; the three data types and the three result levels; the sixth family health survey round of 2023-24 released on 29 May 2026 with stunting at 29.3 per cent against 35.5 per cent; the evaluation office and the output-outcome budget framework; and the Economic Survey finding that transfers improve consumption and food security without consistently improving nutrition, education or durable poverty exit where complementary services are absent. **Analysis:** the survey finding is decisive because it shows the delivery stage working while the outcome stage does not, which locates the constraint in what surrounds the transfer rather than in the transfer itself, and the correction stage then fails to act on that finding because allocation does not depend on it. **Qualification:** the analysis should concede genuine progress in delivery and in stunting reduction, should keep every figure with its round or status date, and should treat the 2027 enumeration as pending rather than as a solution already available.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners state the core proposition as a cycle rather than as a checklist: targeting decides who is eligible, delivery decides how a benefit reaches them, convergence decides how multiple schemes coordinate at the household level, outcome measurement decides what actually changed, and correction decides how evidence feeds back into redesign. They add the decisive rule that no single component substitutes for the others, which is why a scheme-evaluation answer that praises coverage while ignoring outcome, or condemns outcome while ignoring targeting, has assessed one stage and reported it as a verdict on the whole. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Social Assistance Programme of the Ministry of Rural Development is the umbrella non-contributory social-assistance scheme, and the owners record its composition exactly as five components: the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme, the Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme, the National Family Benefit Scheme providing a lump sum on the death of the primary breadwinner, and Annapurna providing food support for elderly persons not covered by a pension. They record that central assistance is fixed while States may top up, and that eligibility is administered through below-poverty-line and State targeting routes which must be specified rather than assumed to be one current list. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the delivery layer as direct benefit transfer working with the identity, bank-account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system and the single nodal agency arrangement for fund flow, together with frontline cadres including the auxiliary nurse midwife, the accredited social health activist, the anganwadi worker and the panchayat secretary, and urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions as the implementing tier. The examinable point is that fund flow and last-mile mediation are different problems, so a reform that accelerates transfers does nothing about a frontline worker who serves one scheme and cannot see the household's other entitlements. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that

convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not.

Analysis: Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners define output as the immediate product such as meals served, outcome as the medium-term change such as nutritional status, and impact as the long-term capability such as cognitive development, and they record which instrument captures which: administrative data typically captures outputs, surveys capture outcomes and evaluations estimate impact. The examinable consequence is that an administration reporting rising outputs is answering a different question from the one an outcome critic is asking, and an answer that keeps the three levels apart can concede genuine output achievement while still sustaining an outcome criticism. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners name the outcome evidence base precisely: the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry for health and nutrition outcomes, the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry for employment outcomes, the National Crime Records Bureau of the home ministry for data on atrocities and crimes against women, children and Scheduled Castes and Tribes, the Sustainable Development Goal India Index of the national policy think tank for composite State-level performance and the Multidimensional Poverty Index for deprivation across health, education and standard of living. They record the current round exactly: the sixth round of the family health survey, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and reports under-five stunting at 29.3 per cent, improved from 35.5 per cent in the fifth round, and they instruct that the round travel with every indicator and that values from two rounds never be silently merged. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
7. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record a specific finding rather than a general endorsement: the Economic Survey of 2025-26 notes that cash transfers can improve short-term consumption and food security without consistently improving child nutrition, education or durable poverty exits when complementary public services and work opportunities are absent. They record its argumentative use with equal precision, that it supports a convergence argument and does not support a claim that transfer coverage alone proves social-sector success, which makes it the single most useful citation for an answer that must concede a real achievement while refusing the inference the achievement is offered to support. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
8. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners set out the outcome-learning failure chain in three steps: administrative dashboards show coverage while surveys show remaining outcome deficits and the divergence is not investigated; the evaluation office of the national policy think tank and third-party evaluations exist but their findings are not systematically fed back into scheme redesign and remain in reports; and governments prefer coverage figures, which are easy to announce, over outcome figures, which are harder to achieve and may be unflattering. They record the institutional instruments that already exist for this purpose, the evaluation office housed in the think tank which coordinates third-party evaluations, and the output-outcome monitoring framework introduced by the finance ministry as a budget-document requirement. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the binding constraint moves as one travels the cycle, sitting in database vintage at targeting, in cadre fragmentation at convergence and in the absence of a funding consequence at correction, so a single reform aimed at any one stage cannot lift performance overall. Named evidence: the five-stage cycle of targeting, delivery, convergence, outcome measurement and correction with the rule that no component substitutes for another; the five-component social-assistance umbrella with fixed central assistance and State top-ups; the 2011 deprivation database with its unreleased caste data and its use alongside an age-based health route; the delivery layer of direct benefit transfer with the identity, account and mobile trinity, the public financial management system, the single nodal agency arrangement and the frontline cadres; the convergence failure chain and its worked tribal-household case; the three data types and the three result levels; the sixth family health survey round of 2023-24 released on 29 May 2026 with stunting at 29.3 per cent against 35.5 per cent; the evaluation office and the output-outcome budget framework; and the Economic Survey finding that transfers improve consumption and food security without consistently improving nutrition, education or durable poverty exit where complementary services are absent. Analysis: the survey finding is decisive because it shows the delivery stage working while the outcome stage does not, which locates the constraint in what surrounds the transfer rather than in the transfer itself, and the correction stage then fails to act on that finding because allocation does not depend on it. Qualification: the analysis should concede genuine progress in delivery and in stunting reduction, should keep every figure with its round or status date, and should treat the 2027 enumeration as pending rather than as a solution already available.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Analyse the complete cycle from targeting to correction and evaluate where India's social-...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the proposition that a rights-respecting data architecture is a precondition for, rather than a threat to, effective welfare delivery. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: the proposition holds, because the safeguards that protect the citizen are the same mechanisms that keep a beneficiary record accurate and usable, so treating rights and efficiency as opposed misdescribes both. Named evidence: the recommended federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access, contrasted with an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; the privacy judgment's requirement of legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards with the rule that verification must not become denial of the entitlement; the targeting-error chain in which authentication and documentation exclude eligible households and de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route; the distinction between administrative, survey and census data and their differing coverage; the district-convergence illustration in which indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming; and the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic. Analysis: a correction right keeps a record current and therefore keeps targeting accurate, an audit trail deters gaming and therefore keeps rankings meaningful, and an assisted non-digital route preserves the enrolment of exactly the households whose exclusion most distorts outcome data, so each safeguard has an administrative pay-off as well as a rights justification. Qualification: the evaluation should concede the real costs, that interoperability creates profiling exposure, that correction machinery is administratively expensive and that participation without decision power delivers neither legitimacy nor accuracy.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits

because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route.

- The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations.
- The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow. The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation.
- The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not.
- The audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes two General Studies Paper II demands to this owner and records both with the note that the core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. The first is the 2019 question numbered 18, whose printed wording states that the performance of welfare schemes implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to the absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of the policy process, with the directive Discuss, fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. The second is the 2023 question numbered 17, whose printed wording states that development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by their nature, are discriminatory in approach, and asks whether the candidate agrees and to give reasons, with fifteen marks and two hundred and fifty words. Both are solved here; the audited 2024-2025 Mains and Prelims ledgers route no further demand to this owner and no other question is claimed.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the proposition holds, because the safeguards that protect the citizen are the same mechanisms that keep a beneficiary record accurate and usable, so treating rights and efficiency as opposed misdescribes both. Named evidence: the recommended federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access, contrasted with an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; the privacy judgment's requirement of legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards with the rule that verification must not become denial of the entitlement; the targeting-error chain in which authentication and documentation exclude eligible households and de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route; the distinction between administrative, survey and census data and their differing coverage; the district-convergence illustration in which indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming; and the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic. Analysis: a correction right keeps a record current and therefore keeps targeting accurate, an audit trail deters gaming and therefore keeps rankings meaningful, and an assisted non-digital route preserves the enrolment of exactly the households whose exclusion most distorts outcome data, so each safeguard has an administrative pay-off as well as a rights justification. Qualification: the evaluation should concede the real costs, that interoperability creates profiling exposure, that correction machinery is administratively

expensive and that participation without decision power delivers neither legitimacy nor accuracy.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on “Evaluate the proposition that a rights-respecting data architecture is a precondition for,...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the proposition holds, because the safeguards that protect the citizen are the same mechanisms that keep a beneficiary record accurate and usable, so treating rights and efficiency as opposed misdescribes both. Named evidence: the recommended federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access, contrasted with an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; the privacy judgment's requirement of legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards with the rule that verification must not become denial of the entitlement; the targeting-error chain in which authentication and documentation exclude eligible households and de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route; the distinction between administrative, survey and census data and their differing coverage; the district-convergence illustration in which indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming; and the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic. Analysis: a correction right keeps a record current and therefore keeps targeting accurate, an audit trail deters gaming and therefore keeps rankings meaningful, and an assisted non-digital route preserves the enrolment of exactly the households whose exclusion most distorts outcome data, so each safeguard has an administrative pay-off as well as a rights justification. Qualification: the evaluation should concede the real costs, that interoperability creates profiling exposure, that correction machinery is administratively expensive and that participation without decision power delivers neither legitimacy nor accuracy.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners set out the targeting-error failure chain in four steps: the 2011 database is over a decade old so that population movement, income change and newly arising deprivation are not captured and the newly poor are excluded; households lacking an identity number, a ration card or a caste certificate cannot access benefits because documentation proxies for identity rather than for need; self-declaration risks inclusion error while certificate-based verification risks exclusion error for genuine claimants without documents; and deprivation criteria such as housing type, land and assets are imperfect proxies for income or consumption poverty that can both include the non-poor and exclude the poor. They add that authentication-based de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record a reform package with its constraints attached. They recommend a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access rather than an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; outcome-linked budget allocation in which incremental funding depends on evaluation-verified outcome improvement rather than coverage expansion; and explicit convergence authority for district collectors with real-time dashboard visibility across central schemes. They record the constitutional limit that the privacy judgment requires legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards and that verification must not become denial of the entitlement, the district-convergence illustration that indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming, the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic, and the equity caution that outcome-linked funding may penalise States with harder-to-reach populations. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners distinguish administrative data, which is high frequency and programme-specific but excludes everyone not enrolled; survey data, which offers comparable indicators but rests on sampling and carries a reporting lag; and census data, which is universal in coverage but infrequent and slow.

The rule that follows is that a question about who is being reached is an administrative question, a question about what changed is a survey question and a question about the total population in a condition is a census question, so citing a dashboard total in answer to an outcome question is a category error rather than merely a weak citation. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners set out the convergence failure chain in four steps: each ministry designs schemes with its own eligibility database so that no universally interoperable beneficiary record exists across schemes; different frontline cadres serve different schemes so that no single worker holds a household-wide view; district collectors are notionally responsible for convergence but lack real-time data and authority over central scheme implementing agencies; and schemes operate on different disbursement cycles so that a household may receive one benefit and miss another purely because of timing. The chain shows that convergence does not happen by default and that exhortation cannot supply what authority and data do not. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

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Qualified conclusion: Claim: the proposition holds, because the safeguards that protect the citizen are the same mechanisms that keep a beneficiary record accurate and usable, so treating rights and efficiency as opposed misdescribes both. Named evidence: the recommended federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with updated beneficiary records, human-assisted correction, audit trails and non-digital access, contrasted with an unchecked all-purpose identity-linked registry; the privacy judgment's requirement of legality, purpose, proportionality and safeguards with the rule that verification must not become denial of the entitlement; the targeting-error chain in which authentication and documentation exclude eligible households and de-duplication must retain assisted and non-digital alternatives and a correction route; the distinction between administrative, survey and census data and their differing coverage; the district-convergence illustration in which indicator-led ranking can favour measurable outputs and invite data gaming; and the participation point that awareness and community monitoring aid uptake and correction while consultation without decision power is tokenistic. Analysis: a correction right keeps a record current and therefore keeps targeting accurate, an audit trail deters gaming and therefore keeps rankings meaningful, and an assisted non-digital route preserves the enrolment of exactly the households whose exclusion most distorts outcome data, so each safeguard has an administrative pay-off as well as a rights justification. Qualification: the evaluation should concede the real costs, that interoperability creates profiling exposure, that correction machinery is administratively expensive and that participation without decision power delivers neither legitimacy nor accuracy.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Evaluate the proposition that a rights-respecting data architecture is a precondition for,...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.